

Monitors blanking out, hard drives collapsing, and dying pen drives.....

Digit breathes life into them

❓ Poor performance in games

I have a Gigabyte G31 motherboard, Intel Dual Core E5400 2.5 GHz processor, 3 GB DDR2 Kingston RAM (800 MHz), 250 GB hard disk and Zotac GeForce 8400 graphics card. When I play *Counter Strike* or *Prince of Persia*, these games don't run smoothly.

Anjan Sahana



The GeForce GT240 is an entry-level gaming card

⚠️ The GeForce 8400GS is a very basic entry-level gaming card. *Counter Strike* should run just about fine, but *Prince of Persia* will most likely not. You can try reinstalling the graphics card drivers to see if there's any improvement in performance. If you like gaming, we recommend that you upgrade your graphics card to something like the GeForce GT240 or the Radeon 5670.

❓ System not starting up

I have an HP Pavillion 8190in desktop PC. It's specifications are:

- Intel Core Duo E6x00 processor
- ASUS P5BW-LA motherboard
- 2 GB RAM

The problem is that it stopped booting. There were two options – one to start normally and the other to run Windows repair. I ran Windows normally, but it failed to start and again the same screen was shown. Then, I chose to run Windows repair, it restarted automati-

cally and the problem was still there. What shall I do now?

Laxman Soni

⚠️ The repair mode should fix problems, if any. If you have a recovery disc, you can use it to restore Windows to its initial state. However, there is a good chance you will lose your data in the process. Check with HP customer care to verify that. You might have to do a Windows Repair using the installation disc. If that fails, you'll have to reinstall Windows.

❓ Poor internet speeds

I recently bought a Samsung Corby mobile phone. I surf the internet using that phone. However, net speeds are really poor for downloading songs. I'm using an Airtel mobile internet plan. I need your help on how to accelerate my net speed.

Linkan Khuntia

⚠️ You're most likely using GPRS to connect to the internet. GPRS connections are extremely slow. Performance also depends on your location, signal strength, and network congestion. There isn't really a way to speed up GPRS connections. Go in for a datacard-based ISP to get better speeds at home.

❓ Sudden death!

I purchased an HP Pavillion DV6 1110AX laptop last July. For the past two months, it's been giving me problems that I can't understand.

My PC configuration is as follows:

- AMD Turion(tm) X2 Dual-Core Mobile RM-74
- ATI Mobility Radeon HD 4650 Series-1GB
- 4 GB RAM
- Windows 7 Ultimate
- Problem report: Problem Event Name: BlueScreen

My laptop suddenly shows me a blue

screen that shows physical memory dumping and restarts again within seconds. I don't even get a chance to take a snapshot, because I don't know when it's about to crash. I also formatted it, but nothing happened. Can you help me out? I'm worried because these hiccups can also damage my hard disk and I can't risk it.

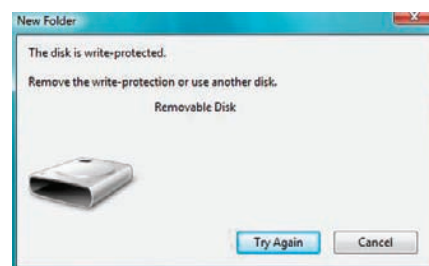
Parth Sarthi

⚠️ The blue screen that appears even after formatting and reinstalling the OS might be due to serious problems with the hardware. Take the laptop to the service centre to have it checked out.

❓ Pen drive disk protected

I have a 4 GB Kingston pen drive. It is affected by a virus. Because of this virus, my pen drive is not working. Whenever I try to format the pen drive, a message appears on the screen "the disk is write protected". I cannot copy or transfer data to it. Also, I tried many updated antivirus programs. They detect the virus, but do not delete it. Please give me a solution?

Ashutosh Khulbe



Flash drive shown as write-protected

⚠️ Your PC might also be infected by the worm or virus. Connect the flash drive to a PC running Linux and try formatting the drive using it. If you connect it to a Windows PC, make sure you don't use the Autorun function. Open Windows Explorer, then right click on the flash drive and format it.